HONGYI CHEN

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Hongyi Chen is a game designer, creative technologist, and filmmaker. His work explores emerging technologies, new forms of interaction, and cinematic storytelling to create meaningful and thought-provoking experiences.

EDUCATION

Emory University — Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — GPA: 3.91/4.00
Atlanta, GA — Minor in Media Production — Expected May 2027

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Emory University TReAD Lab / Unity Developer
Atlanta, GA · 10/2025 - 5/2026

Independently developed Sky Climber, a Unity-based behavioral research game designed in collaboration with Emory's TReAD Lab, where participants climb through repeated tapping under varying effort and reward conditions. Translated psychological research requirements into interactive gameplay mechanics to study motivation and decision-making.

Film Production Crew / Independent Film & Television Productions
Atlanta & Beijing · 02/2025 - Present

Worked across film and television productions as Assistant Camera, Gaffer, and Key Grip. Supported cinematography, lighting, and large-scale studio shoots with constructed sets and professional equipment.

Aperture Film Festival / Inaugural Organizing Team
Atlanta, GA · 01/2025 - 04/2025

Helped organize the inaugural Aperture International Student Film Festival at Atlanta's Plaza Theatre, contributing to the selection of 16 films from 100+ international submissions, festival programming, and event coordination.

DiDi Global Inc. / Tech/Data Analyst Intern
Beijing, China · 5/2024 - 8/2024

Developed and deployed two LLM-powered APIs to automate information extraction from 10,000+ freight order screenshots, achieving over 99% extraction accuracy and streamlining operational workflows.

PROJECTS

Polaroid of Yesterday (First-Person Narrative Puzzle Game, 2026)

A photographer with dissociative amnesia searches for his missing girlfriend, using Polaroid photography to reconstruct fragmented memories and uncover a disturbing truth.

• **Narrative Mechanics:** Designed and developed a photography-driven system where limited film and player-selected evidence shape how the story is experienced and interpreted.
• **Environmental & Cinematic Storytelling:** Combined spatial guidance and monochromatic 3D environments with original live-action filmmaking, contrasting subjective perception with representations of past events.

GRAN TURISMO (VR Adventure Game, 2026)

A lone space explorer returns to find his civilization vanished, embarking on an odyssey through cosmic ruins to discover the fate of his people and the home he has lost.

• **Spatial Mechanics:** Designed a VR traversal system combining Star Stone teleportation, handheld thrusters, and limited oxygen and fuel, turning spatial navigation into a resource-driven challenge.
• **Environmental & Narrative Design:** Created a minimalist, high-contrast world of cosmic ruins and monoliths, using environmental storytelling and visual symbolism to explore themes of home, migration, and belonging.

User Manual of Vibe Coding for Game Design (Experimental Game Design Research, 2026)

A practice-based research project combining three AI-assisted games—a puzzle game, a platformer, and a puzzle-combat game—with an interactive handbook exploring human–AI collaboration in game design.

• **Design Experiments:** Explored progressively greater AI autonomy across game development, from implementing predefined designs to collaborative creation and AI-guided concept development.
• **Research & Documentation:** Documented creative decisions, development iterations, and reflections to investigate how AI reshapes creative control, prototyping, and the role of the human game designer.

Figures of Speech (Creative Coding & Interaction Design, 2026)

Designed and developed a collection of interactive web experiments exploring computational expression, motion, and physical metaphors to transform conventional interfaces into playful, expressive experiences.

World Sensing Music Station (Interactive Music Installation, 2025)

Designed and built an interactive music installation that translates environmental sensor inputs into musical interactions, exploring how physical computing can connect the surrounding world with digital sound.

SKILLS

Programming & XR: Unity, C#, Python, VR Development
Physical Computing & Fabrication: Microcontrollers, Sensors, 3D Printing, Laser Cutting
Design & Media Tools: Figma, Blender, Photoshop, DaVinci Resolve